

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 3 · AMAZING STORIES

Grammar

B1+/B2

Past Ability & Being/Becoming Accustomed To · Degree Modifiers: Slightly, Fairly, Extremely, Absolutely

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Discover the grammar from examples, explain the rule in your own words and use it correctly in context.

Past Ability & Being/Becoming Accustomed To

1 · NOTICE

- As a child, she **could** already solve maths problems that confused adults.
- After months of practice, he finally **was able to** repair the old radio himself.
- By the time she moved to the city, she **was used to** working long, unpredictable hours.
- It took him almost a year to **get used to** writing with his left hand after the accident.

Which sentences describe a general ability someone had in the past, which describe a single successful achievement, and which describe becoming or being familiar with something?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

a general past ability one specific achievement already familiar (a state)
the process of becoming familiar

- 'Could' + verb describes _____.
- 'Was/were able to' + verb often describes _____, especially when there was some difficulty.
- 'Be used to' + -ing describes being _____.
- 'Get used to' + -ing describes _____.

B Build sentences

Use the cues to build true or plausible sentences about amazing lives.

e.g. she could / read fluently by the age of four

She could read fluently by the age of four.

- against the odds, the climber be able to / reach the summit despite the storm

- as a boy, he could / repair engines without any training

3. after years at sea, the sailor be used to / sleeping in rough weather
-
4. it took her months get used to / living in a completely new country
-
5. ? / the inventor ever / be able to / convince the investors on the first try
-

C Your turn

Write four sentences about yourself or someone you know: one about a general childhood ability, one about a single achievement, and two about getting or being used to something new.

As a child, I could...

After a lot of practice, I was finally able to...

I'm still not used to...

It took me a while to get used to...

RULE

'Could' describes a general past ability. 'Was/were able to' describes one specific achievement, often despite difficulty. 'Be used to + -ing' describes an existing state of familiarity, while 'get used to + -ing' describes the process of becoming familiar with something.

TR Geçmişteki genel bir yeteneği anlatmak için 'could' kullanılır. Belirli, tek bir başarıyı (özellikle zorluğa rağmen) anlatmak için 'was/were able to' kullanılır. 'Be used to + -ing' bir duruma zaten alışkın olmayı, 'get used to + -ing' ise o duruma alışma sürecini ifade eder.

When?

Use 'could' for a general childhood or long-term ability; use 'was/were able to' for one difficult achievement; use 'be used to' for an existing state of familiarity; use 'get used to' for the process of becoming familiar with something new.

TR Genel bir çocukluk yeteneğini anlatırken 'could'; tek seferlik, zor bir başarıyı anlatırken 'was/were able to'; birine zaten alışkın olduğunu belirtirken 'be used to'; yeni bir duruma alışma sürecini anlatırken 'get used to' kullanılır.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
She could speak three languages by the age of ten.	He couldn't swim before he took up the sport.	Could you read before you started school?	Yes, I could. / No, I couldn't.
He was able to finish the marathon despite the injury.	She wasn't able to convince them at first.	Was she able to finish the project on time?	Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't.
They are used to working under pressure.	We aren't used to such extreme weather.	Are you used to the new system yet?	Yes, I am. / No, not yet.
I'm getting used to the new schedule.	I still haven't got used to waking up so early.	Did it take long to get used to the change?	

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
After years of training, she could finally win the competition.	After years of training, she was finally able to win the competition.	For a single successful achievement, especially a difficult one, use 'was/were able to', not 'could'. TR Zor bir görevde tek seferlik bir başarı anlatılırken 'could' değil, 'was/were able to' kullanılır.
I am used to wake up early now.	I am used to waking up early now.	'Be used to' is followed by the -ing form, not the base verb, because 'to' here is a preposition, not part of an infinitive. TR 'Be used to' bir fiil kökü ile değil, -ing formuyla kullanılır, çünkü burada 'to' bir edattır.
She used to living in a big city, so the small town felt strange.	She wasn't used to living in a big city, so the small town didn't feel strange. / She used to live in a big city.	'Used to + base verb' describes a past habit; 'be/get used to + -ing' means being or becoming familiar with something — the two structures are easy to confuse. TR 'Used to + verb kökü' geçmişteki alışkanlıkları anlatır; 'be/get used to + -ing' ise alışkın olma/alışma anlamına gelir — ikisi karıştırılmamalıdır.

1 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- As a young girl, Elena _____ compose short pieces of music by ear.
☐ a could ☐ b was able to ☐ c is used to
- Despite the broken equipment, the team _____ finish the experiment on time.
☐ a could ☐ b was able to ☐ c used to
- After ten years abroad, he _____ speaking a mix of three languages every day.
☐ a could ☐ b is used to ☐ c was able to

2 Complete with the correct form.

3 × 1 pts

1. It took her almost a year to _____ (get used to) living without electricity on the island.
2. Against the odds, the young scientist _____ (be able to) publish her first paper at seventeen.
3. As a child, he _____ (can) recognise every bird in the forest by its call.

3 Judge the sentence.

3 × 1 pts

1. After months of practice, she could finally perform the piece perfectly at the concert.
☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

2. He still isn't used to work such long hours. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

3. As a teenager, she could already fix almost any bicycle. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

4 Complete with the correct form.

2 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. A: _____ (can) you read music before you joined the orchestra?
2. B: A little, yes. But it took me months to really _____ (get used to) sight-reading fast enough.

5 Reorder the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. odds, against was she finish to the the able race .

Degree Modifiers: Slightly, Fairly, Extremely, Absolutely

1 · NOTICE

- The results were only **slightly** better than the team had expected.
- Her first attempt was **fairly** successful, but far from perfect.
- The whole project turned out to be **extremely** difficult in the end.
- Everyone agreed that his recovery was **absolutely** incredible.

Which degree modifiers make an adjective a little stronger, which make it moderately strong, which make it very strong, and which are only used with 'extreme' adjectives that already mean 100%?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

gradable adjectives

ungradable (extreme) adjectives

a small degree

a very high degree

- 'Slightly' and 'fairly' are typically used with _____ (e.g. good, difficult, successful), which can exist in degrees.
- 'Extremely' also modifies gradable adjectives, showing _____.
- 'Absolutely' is typically used with _____ (e.g. incredible, amazing, impossible), which already mean 100% and cannot be 'more' or 'less'.

B Build sentences

Use the cues to build true or plausible sentences with the correct degree modifier.

e.g. the story absolutely / incredible everyone agreed

Everyone agreed the story was absolutely incredible.

- the first results slightly / disappointing compared to expectations
- his plan fairly / risky but not impossible
- the journey across the desert extremely / dangerous according to the guide
- the ending of the story absolutely / unbelievable when you hear it
- ? / the challenge extremely / difficult for the first team

C Your turn

Write four sentences about an amazing story you know or can imagine, using a different degree modifier (slightly, fairly, extremely, absolutely) in each one.

At first, the story seemed only slightly...

Honestly, I found it fairly...

By the end, the situation was extremely...

In my opinion, the whole thing was absolutely...

RULE

Degree modifiers show how strong an adjective is. 'Slightly' (a little) and 'fairly' (moderately) are used with gradable adjectives (good, difficult); 'extremely' is also used with gradable adjectives but shows a very high degree. 'Absolutely' is used with ungradable/extreme adjectives that already mean 100% (incredible, impossible, amazing).

TR Derece zarfları (degree modifiers) bir sıfatın gücünü belirtir. 'Slightly' (hafifçe) ve 'fairly' (oldukça) derecelendirilebilen sıfatlarla (good, difficult) kullanılır; 'extremely' (son derece) da aynı tür sıfatlarla ama çok güçlü bir derece belirtir. 'Absolutely' (kesinlikle) ise zaten %100 anlamı taşıyan, derecelendirilemeyen sıfatlarla (incredible, impossible, amazing) kullanılır.

When?

We use degree modifiers when we want to be precise about how strong a quality is — for example, how surprising a story is, or how difficult an achievement was.

TR Bir durumun ne kadar 'derecede' olduğunu netleştirmek istediğimizde, örneğin bir hikayenin ne kadar şaşırtıcı ya da bir başarının ne kadar zor olduğunu anlatırken derece zarflarını kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
The story was slightly exaggerated, but mostly true. Her achievement was absolutely remarkable.	The task wasn't extremely difficult, just fairly time-consuming. It isn't slightly unusual — it's absolutely astonishing.	Was the journey extremely dangerous? Is the story absolutely true, or slightly exaggerated?	Yes, extremely. / No, only slightly. Yes, absolutely. / No, not really.
✗ WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?	
The ending was very absolutely amazing.	The ending was absolutely amazing.	'Absolutely' already shows the highest degree, so it isn't combined with 'very'. TR 'Absolutely' zaten en yüksek derece anlamı taşır, bu yüzden 'very' ile birlikte kullanılmaz.	
The plan was absolutely risky.	The plan was extremely risky. / The plan was fairly risky.	'Risky' is a gradable adjective, so it takes 'extremely' or 'fairly', not 'absolutely'. TR 'Risky' derecelendirilebilen bir sıfattır, bu yüzden 'absolutely' değil, 'extremely' veya 'fairly' ile kullanılır.	
It was slightly incredible how she survived.	It was absolutely incredible how she survived.	'Incredible' is an ungradable/extreme adjective; it goes with 'absolutely', not with degree words like 'slightly'. TR 'Incredible' ungradable/aşırı bir sıfattır; 'slightly' gibi derece belirten zarflarla değil, 'absolutely' ile kullanılır.	

6 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- Her first attempt at the language exam was _____ successful — she passed, but only just.
 (a) absolutely (b) fairly (c) utterly
- When the truth came out, everyone found the story _____ unbelievable.
 (a) slightly (b) fairly (c) absolutely
- The mountain path was _____ steeper than the map suggested — nothing dramatic, just a bit more effort.
 (a) absolutely (b) slightly (c) totally

7 Complete with the correct modifier.

3 × 1 pts

- The final challenge turned out to be _____ (very high degree) difficult, far harder than anyone expected.
- I found the ending _____ (100%) astonishing — I still can't believe it happened.
- The interview was _____ (moderate degree) interesting, though not the most exciting part of the documentary.

8 Judge the sentence.

3 × 1 pts

- The rescue mission was extremely impossible to complete in one day. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

- Her progress was slightly noticeable after just one week of practice. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

- The whole audience agreed the performance was absolutely brilliant. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

9 Complete with the correct modifier.

2 × 1 pts

Challenge

- A: Was the climb _____ (very) exhausting?
- B: Honestly, it was _____ (100%) unbearable near the top, but only _____ (a little) hard at the start.

10 Reorder the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

- the story found absolutely everyone astonishing .